Baton Rouge, LA

Strategic IT Landscape and Market Analysis Report

April 3, 2026

1. Executive Summary & Macro Landscape

The City of Baton Rouge and the Parish of East Baton Rouge (City-Parish) is currently navigating one of the most volatile, constrained, and transformative periods in its modern municipal history. Entering the 2026 fiscal year, the local government is defined by a seismic shift in executive political leadership, unprecedented macroeconomic constraints driven by municipal secession, and an aggressive, survival-driven pivot toward artificial intelligence and digital automation to maintain baseline civic operations.

In a pivotal runoff election held on December 7, 2024, Republican challenger Emile "Sidward" (Sid) Edwards unseated two-term incumbent Democratic Mayor-President Sharon Weston Broome, securing 54.12% of the vote.[1] Sworn into office on January 2, 2025, Mayor-President Edwards represents a profound departure from traditional political orthodoxy.[3] A lifelong educator and former high school football coach with 35 years of experience across institutions such as Catholic High, Redemptorist, Jesuit, Menard, Central High, and Istrouma, Edwards entered the highest office in the Parish with no prior political experience.[5] His administration is characterized by a populist, grassroots methodology, emphasizing a "God-driven" approach to governance, community loyalty, and a fierce dedication to bridging the economic divide between affluent districts and historically underserved areas, particularly North Baton Rouge.[5]

However, the Edwards administration inherited a severe and immediate fiscal crisis, catalyzed primarily by the successful incorporation of the neighboring City of St. George. The breakaway of St. George has excised a massive portion of the Parish's affluent tax base, resulting in an estimated $50 million revenue loss over the past two years.[7] To balance the $1.1 billion FY 2026 budget without depleting emergency reserves or risking the City-Parish's Double-A Two bond rating, the Edwards administration proposed a drastic $15 million (4.46%) reduction to the General Fund.[7] This financial triage is being realized through a staggering 33% reduction in the General Fund workforce (excluding Police and Fire departments), involving the elimination of approximately 420 civilian positions through a combination of layoffs, early retirements, and the permanent deletion of unfilled vacancies.[7]

Because of these extreme fiscal limitations, the City-Parish's approach to enterprise technology has rapidly evolved from a model of continuous, innovation-driven digital expansion to one of acute operational survival. The sudden reduction in human capital across all civilian agencies mandates the immediate deployment of technological force multipliers. Consequently, the top administrative and technological goals for the current fiscal year include the following strategic pillars:

First, the administration is deeply committed to public safety and combatting violent crime. Mayor-President Edwards campaigned heavily on restoring law and order, promising to hire 100 new police officers to combat a severe staffing deficit within the Baton Rouge Police Department (BRPD).[6] In March 2026, the administration announced a historic $7.5 million mid-year pay raise for BRPD personnel, establishing a $58,000 starting salary to stem the attrition of veteran officers to higher-paying regional departments.[8] Technologically, this public

safety mandate is supported by the continued expansion of the Real Time Crime Center (RTCC), which leverages advanced surveillance integrations, despite broader budget pressures forcing the termination of expensive operational contracts like ShotSpotter.[8]

Second, the City-Parish is executing an aggressive pivot toward Artificial Intelligence (AI) and workforce automation. With the Information Services (IS) department and other civilian agencies operating at a 33% personnel deficit, the government can no longer rely on human capital for routine data processing, call routing, or analytical triage.[7] The City-Parish is actively pursuing AI automation for its 311 citizen request call centers and utilizing advanced data analytics to inform decision-making around code enforcement, blight reduction, and building demolition.[11]

Third, the administration aims to maintain digital equity, systemic transparency, and strict infrastructure compliance. Baton Rouge has been named a "Top 10 Digital City" by the Center for Digital Government for 11 consecutive years, winning first place in its population category in the 2025 survey.[8] The city views digital transparency not just as a civic duty, but as a critical mechanism for maintaining public trust amidst severe budget cuts. This is evidenced by the recent launch of the IT Capital Projects Dashboard in late 2025, which provides residents with real-time updates on major infrastructure spending.[8]

For enterprise technology vendors, and specifically for Dell Technologies, the current landscape in Baton Rouge presents a unique, high-urgency sales environment. The City-Parish is highly motivated to invest in Capital Expenditure (CapEx) solutions—such as AI-ready edge compute, automated storage tiers, and highly secure client endpoints—that permanently reduce Operating Expenditure (OpEx) and mitigate the operational fallout of the 33% reduction in the civilian workforce.

2. Power Structure & Key Stakeholders

The technological and financial power structure in Baton Rouge has been thoroughly disrupted over the past eighteen months. This disruption is the result of the recent change in the executive branch, a sweeping reorganization of the General Fund budget, and the concurrent retirement of long-time, entrenched IT leadership. In January 2026, Eric Romero, the Chief Information Officer who successfully led the Information Services department since 2012 and served the city for over three decades, officially retired.[13]

Romero was immediately replaced by Rizwan Ahmed, a highly experienced enterprise technologist who previously served as the State of Louisiana's Chief Information Officer from 2006 to 2008, where he oversaw an $850 million technology budget.[13] This leadership transition signals a definitive shift from a localized, support-oriented IT department toward enterprise-scale governance, rigorous AI adoption, and strict infrastructure modernization. The following table categorizes the key decision-makers, financial purchasers, and technical influencers relevant to enterprise technology acquisitions within the City-Parish.

Name & Title	Sphere of Influence	Recent Public Stances on Technology & Operations
Sid Edwards Mayor-President, City of Baton Rouge & East Baton Rouge Parish	**Financial Purchaser / Executive Sponsor** Holds ultimate veto and budget presentation authority over the $1.1B consolidated budget.	Champions a community-first, law-and-order administration.[6] Publicly launched the IT Capital Projects Dashboard to guarantee taxpayer transparency regarding infrastructure spend.[8] Demonstrated a willingness to cut civilian administrative staff by 33% to fund a historic $7.5M police pay raise, signaling a prioritization of frontline operations over administrative bloat.[7]
Dr. Christel Slaughter Acting Chief Administrative Officer (CAO)	**Executive Decision Maker / Operational Gatekeeper** Manages day-to-day government operations while leading the search for a permanent CAO.	Appointed in September 2025 by Mayor Edwards. Brings over 30 years of experience in organizational change, performance improvement, and strategic planning, making her a vital stakeholder in how the administration executes its operational agenda.
Rizwan Ahmed Chief Information Officer, Director of Information Services	**Technical Decision Maker / Financial Influencer** Controls the central IT budget, defines the overarching architectural strategy, and approves all enterprise hardware/software standards.	Tasked explicitly upon his hiring with overseeing AI governance, AI adoption, infrastructure modernization, and enterprise security.[13] Brings massive state-level experience to a heavily constrained municipal environment, indicating a preference for scalable, enterprise-grade architectures over localized, bespoke solutions.[13]

Name & Title	Sphere of Influence	Recent Public Stances on Technology & Operations
Thomas S. Morse Jr. Chief of Police, Baton Rouge Police Department (BRPD)	**Business Owner / Influencer** Controls specialized grant funding and heavily influences the technology stack within the BRPD's Real Time Crime Center (RTCC).	Deeply focused on intelligence-led policing, departmental transparency, and officer wellness.[16] Operates the RTCC using complex integrations of Genetec, Axon, and Motorola platforms.[9] Openly admitted that high recurring OpEx costs forced the City to terminate its ShotSpotter contract, demonstrating a keen sensitivity to vendor subscription pricing.[10]
Emily Stephens Budgeting Manager, Finance Department	**Financial Gatekeeper** Executes cost analyses for proposed IT projects, reviews budgetary amendments, and controls fund allocations within the Finance division.	Heavily focused on maintaining the City-Parish's Double-A Two bond rating amidst the St. George revenue crisis.[7] Enforces the strict administration policy of forbidding the use of one-time reserve monies for recurring operational expenses (O&M).[7]
Warren Kron GIS Manager, Information Services	**Technical Influencer** Manages the city's extensive geographic, topographic, and open data platforms.	Focuses heavily on digital storytelling through complex data visualization. Driven the creation of comprehensive, public-facing dashboards for COVID-19, blight tracking, and capital projects.[19] Represents a major internal consumer of high-performance computing, requiring robust visualization infrastructure and advanced mobile workstations.

Note: Data Unavailable regarding the exact individual currently occupying the role of Chief Information Security Officer (CISO) for the City-Parish of Baton Rouge. While Chase Hymel is listed as the CISO for the State of Louisiana (located in Baton Rouge), municipal cybersecurity initiatives for the City-Parish are currently directed centrally out of the CIO's office under

Rizwan Ahmed.[13]

To successfully penetrate this account, sales executives must understand the psychological and operational incentives driving these stakeholders. Mayor-President Edwards is inherently skeptical of bureaucratic bloat and is highly incentivized to deliver visible, tangible improvements to public safety and basic infrastructure (e.g., roads, drainage).[7] Therefore, any technology pitch to the executive level must be framed not as an IT upgrade, but as a direct enabler of police efficiency or public works acceleration.

CIO Rizwan Ahmed faces the daunting challenge of executing state-level enterprise strategies on a fractured municipal budget. He must automate the workloads of 420 eliminated employees while securing a sprawling hybrid network.[7] Ahmed will be highly receptive to vendors who offer consolidated, pre-validated infrastructure solutions—such as AI-ready converged infrastructure or fully managed consumption models—that reduce the integration burden on his depleted engineering staff.

Meanwhile, the Finance Department, guided by personnel like Emily Stephens and the broader directives of the Mayor's office, operates under a strict mandate of austerity. Because the administration refuses to use reserve funds for recurring operating expenses, technology proposals that carry escalating, unpredictable, or heavily recurring OpEx (such as aggressive public cloud consumption models) will face extreme scrutiny.[7] Conversely, solutions that can be capitalized upfront, bonded, or funded via state capital outlay grants will find a much smoother path through the procurement cycle.

3. IT Governance & Service Delivery Model

Operating Model: Centralized, Consolidated, and Expanding

The City-Parish of East Baton Rouge utilizes a highly **Consolidated and Centralized** Information Technology service delivery model.[21] Historically, prior to 2012, IT functions within the local government were somewhat federated, focusing merely on delivering basic core services such as rudimentary network management and siloed server administration.[21] However, under the tenure of former CIO Eric Romero, the Information Services (IS) department aggressively evolved away from department-specific tools in favor of an integrated, Central IT support service agency.[21]

Today, the IS department serves as the sole authority for enterprise architecture, providing network support, application development, telecommunications, ERP management, cybersecurity, and Geographic Information Systems (GIS) for more than 4,000 full-time municipal employees across dozens of agencies.[13] This centralized approach has been the driving force behind the city's consistent recognition as a top digital municipality, allowing for the standardization of hardware, the unification of software licensing, and the elimination of shadow IT across the parish.[21]

However, the operating model has recently undergone a profound and highly complex

evolution into a hybrid Managed Service Provider (MSP) framework. This shift was necessitated by the secession and official incorporation of the City of St. George. On April 4, 2025, Mayor-President Sid Edwards announced a landmark Intergovernmental Agreement with St. George designed to protect the City-Parish from liability and stabilize budgeting during the transition period.[42] Under the terms of this agreement, the City-Parish of Baton Rouge's IS department continues to provide critical digital infrastructure services to the newly independent City of St. George.[23]

Specifically, Baton Rouge's central IT infrastructure is actively managing the 311 citizen request ticketing system for St. George residents, routing requests for pothole repairs and drainage issues to the appropriate municipal crews, while also managing complex floodplain data and tax collection routing mechanisms.[25] Consequently, Baton Rouge's enterprise architecture is now effectively servicing two distinct municipalities. This mandates a high degree of multi-tenant data segmentation, cross-jurisdictional network routing, and rigorous access control to ensure that the data of East Baton Rouge Parish remains cleanly partitioned from the sovereign data of St. George.

Operational Friction Points and Chargeback Dynamics

This expanded operational mandate arrives at the exact moment the IS department is facing severe personnel contraction. The 33% reduction in the General Fund workforce means that central IT must support the same geographical footprint, maintain the same number of endpoints, and service an entirely separate independent city with significantly fewer technicians, system administrators, and helpdesk personnel.[7] This dichotomy has created several acute friction points within the service delivery model.

Friction Point 1: The Automation Deficit and Workforce Exhaustion Former CIO Eric Romero openly acknowledged the operational reality of the budget cuts prior to his departure, stating that with a reduced staff, the IS team "will still be able to do the tasks that are necessary, but will not be able to do them as efficiently as before".[11] The primary friction point lies in the immediate operational gap between the loss of human capital and the full deployment of the AI automation tools required to replace those workflows. Central IT is experiencing a massive bottleneck in Tier 1 and Tier 2 support requests, ticket routing, and routine infrastructure patching. The department desperately needs autonomous infrastructure management tools—such as predictive hardware analytics, automated storage tiering, and self-healing network protocols—to alleviate the burden on the remaining engineering staff.

Friction Point 2: Indirect Cost Allocation and Cross-Jurisdictional Chargebacks Because the Baton Rouge IS department is providing critical services to the City of St. George, accurate and legally defensible chargebacks are absolutely paramount. The City-Parish must recover the costs for shared infrastructure (such as the compute cycles powering the 311 CRM, the storage housing the floodplain data, and the software licenses enabling the routing) without violating local tax agreements or federal grant stipulations.[25]

The Parish utilizes formal Indirect Cost Allocation Plans (ICAP) to meticulously bill departmental

overhead and recover shared costs.[26] Extreme friction occurs when central IT attempts to allocate backend infrastructure costs to distinct agencies—or to the independent government of St. George—if the underlying physical hardware lacks deep telemetry, granular usage-based metering, or robust multi-tenancy capabilities. If the IS department cannot accurately prove exactly how much storage or compute St. George is consuming, they cannot legally charge back for those services, resulting in Baton Rouge taxpayers inadvertently subsidizing a neighboring city.

Friction Point 3: The CapEx vs. OpEx Procurement Paradox The Budgeting Division, under the strict guidance of the Mayor's office, has expressly forbidden the use of one-time reserve funds for recurring operational expenditures.[7] Therefore, any IT service delivery strategy that relies on unpredictable, escalating monthly consumption fees (such as traditional public cloud models) faces immense friction during the procurement and budget review cycles. The central IT authority is highly constrained in its ability to procure software-as-a-service (SaaS) or infrastructure-as-a-service (IaaS) solutions if those solutions cannot be definitively capped. The entity heavily prefers capitalized hardware assets that can be purchased outright, bonded, or funded via one-time capital outlay grants, forcing the IS department to architect around on-premises or co-located private cloud environments.

4. Financials & Budget Breakdown

Total & IT Budget

For the 2026 fiscal year, the City-Parish of East Baton Rouge operates with a total consolidated budget of approximately $1.1 billion.[7] However, for technology vendors attempting to forecast available funding, this top-line number is highly deceptive. Approximately 71% of this total budget consists of highly restricted special funds with dedicated, legally bound revenue streams.[7] These funds are explicitly earmarked by taxpayers or the state legislature for specific purposes, such as mosquito abatement, specific road maintenance projects, or the Council on Aging, and cannot be repurposed for general enterprise IT modernization.[7]

The critical financial battleground for overarching civic operations and enterprise technology funding is the daily operations fund, formally known as the General Fund. For FY 2026, the General Fund is set at $332 million.[7] Because of the estimated $50 million revenue loss associated with the incorporation of St. George over the past two years, the 2026 General Fund was slashed by approximately $15 million.[7] This massive deficit precipitated the aforementioned layoffs and the 33% reduction in the civilian workforce.[7]

- **IT Specifics:** Data Unavailable regarding the exact, final approved FY 2026 Information Services line-item budget due to current municipal reporting limitations and the ongoing execution of the budget cuts. However, historical baselines provide crucial context. In FY 2025, the IS division operating budget was exactly $7.91 million.[13] Given the Mayor's mandate that most non-public-safety departments sustain an average budget reduction of 11% for FY 2026 to balance the General Fund, the Information Services operating

budget is currently operating under extreme austerity, estimated to be tightly constrained around the $7 million mark.[7]

- **Capital vs. O&M Dichotomy:** The Edwards administration's fiscal policy explicitly and rigidly differentiates between recurring Operational & Maintenance (O&M) spend and net-new project/capital investments. O&M budgets are being ruthlessly audited, slashed, and minimized to align with the diminished tax base.[7] Conversely, capital investments—especially those categorized under "Capital Outlay Projects" for physical infrastructure, flood mitigation, and digital transparency—are viewed as essential, long-term civic investments.[7] These capital projects can be financed through municipal bonds (supported by the City's affirmed Double-A Two bond rating) or funded via state legislative matching grants.[7]
- **Fiscal Boundaries:** The City-Parish fiscal year aligns precisely with the standard calendar year (January 1 – December 31).[29] Consequently, Q3 and Q4 (July through November) represent the critical periods for departmental budget hearings, project scoping, and the execution of end-of-year surplus spending.

Grants & Funding Influxes

While the local General Fund is deeply distressed, Baton Rouge actively leverages substantial federal and state grant mechanisms to fund technology modernization. These alternative funding streams are critical, as they effectively shield specific IT initiatives from local austerity measures.

- **State and Local Cybersecurity Grant Program (SLCGP):** The Federal Emergency Management Agency (FEMA) and the Cybersecurity and Infrastructure Security Agency (CISA) have allocated funds directly applicable to local municipal modernization. For FY25, the State of Louisiana was allocated a total of $1,637,992, with maximum awards capped at $200,000 per local applicant.[30] These funds are explicitly restricted and heavily audited; they cannot be used to supplant existing local IT funds, pay ransomware demands, or construct physical facilities.[30] They must be utilized exclusively for net-new cyber resilience, systemic risk reduction, and the implementation of zero-trust architectures. The grant requires a 20% cost-share/match from the local entity.[30] The project performance period for these funds extends through June 30, 2027, providing a defined window for vendors to architect security solutions.[30]
- **American Rescue Plan (ARP):** The City-Parish continues to utilize interest earnings from its original American Rescue Plan allocations to fund outside support agencies (e.g., the Public Defender, local food banks).[7] Furthermore, original ARP capital tranches were heavily utilized to fund major digital equity initiatives and the development of comprehensive stormwater and drainage data dashboards.[7]
- **State Capital Outlay and Legislative Prioritization:** Mayor-President Edwards is actively lobbying the Louisiana state legislature for massive capital outlay funding targeting major physical infrastructure.[7] High-priority targets include structural repairs to the Raising Cane's River Center, the East Baton Rouge Parish Flood Risk Reduction

Project, and extensive roadway improvements.[7] Crucially for IT vendors, any major physical infrastructure upgrade inevitably includes substantial embedded technology requirements, including edge networking, high-definition IP surveillance, and IoT edge compute nodes.

5. Strategic Initiatives & Projects

Based on an exhaustive analysis of the administration's public mandates, the legislative agenda, and the severe constraints of the fiscal environment, the following represent the top three funded modernization efforts currently active within the City-Parish. These initiatives are ripe for aggressive technology vendor insertion.

Initiative 1: AI-Driven Operational Automation and Civic Governance

- **The Executive Mandate:** The Edwards administration is faced with an impossible mathematical reality: it must maintain municipal service levels, repair potholes, clear blight, and answer constituent calls despite a 33% reduction in the General Fund civilian workforce. To bridge this massive operational gap, the administration's mandate is to aggressively leverage Artificial Intelligence for task automation, intelligent data routing, and augmented civic decision-making.[11]
- **The Specific High-Spend Agency Owning It:** The Department of Information Services, under the leadership of the newly appointed CIO, Rizwan Ahmed. Upon his hiring, Ahmed was specifically and publicly directed to oversee "AI governance, AI adoption, modernization, infrastructure and security".[13]
- **The Underlying IT Requirement:** The City-Parish is actively exploring the deployment of AI within its 311 call centers to manage and route complex constituent requests.[11] This is particularly critical as the 311 center is now responsible for triaging requests for both Baton Rouge and the newly independent City of St. George, necessitating intelligent, automated routing algorithms.[23] Furthermore, the city is utilizing advanced data analytics and AI algorithms to inform decision-making around code enforcement and the triage of building demolition for blighted properties.[11] To execute this, the City-Parish requires a robust, high-performance AI-ready infrastructure. Because of the sensitivity of civic data and the complexities of AI governance, they cannot rely solely on public cloud AI models. The underlying requirement is for high-density, on-premises compute optimized for machine learning (GPU-accelerated servers), secure data pipelines that comply with local governance standards, and massive unstructured data storage arrays capable of housing the historical civic datasets required to train and refine localized AI models.

Initiative 2: Real Time Crime Center (RTCC) Consolidation and Edge Expansion

- **The Executive Mandate:** Mayor-President Edwards campaigned fiercely on a promise to make Baton Rouge the safest mid-sized city in the country.[31] A core operational pillar of

this mandate is the implementation of intelligence-led policing. The administration has proven it is willing to fund public safety at historic levels, evidenced by the staggering $7.5 million mid-year police pay raise, even while cutting other departments to the bone.[8]

- **The Specific High-Spend Agency Owning It:** The Baton Rouge Police Department (BRPD), under the command of Chief Thomas S. Morse Jr., specifically the Operational Services and Special Operations divisions which manage the Real Time Crime Center (RTCC).[9]
- **The Underlying IT Requirement:** The Baton Rouge RTCC serves as the central nervous system for regional law enforcement, aggregating thousands of live video feeds and sensor data to assist first responders.[9] The RTCC operates on a highly complex, multi-vendor software stack, heavily utilizing Genetec (Citigraf and Omnicast VMS), Axon (body cameras, Fleet cameras, and the newly acquired Fusus real-time platform), and Motorola solutions for computer-aided dispatch and ALPR (Automated License Plate Recognition).[17] However, this sprawling technology footprint is generating unsustainable data growth and exorbitant operational costs. This is compounded by the fact that BRPD recently lost over $9 million from its budget following the St. George incorporation, which forced the department to halt extra gun violence prevention patrols. Recently, severe budget cuts also forced the BRPD to eliminate its $400,000 annual contract for ShotSpotter acoustic surveillance, proving that high, recurring OpEx subscriptions are a critical vulnerability even within heavily funded public safety agencies.[10] The underlying IT requirement is the urgent transition from expensive, siloed cloud video surveillance architectures to highly efficient, unified Edge computing and on-premises storage. The BRPD requires ruggedized edge servers to process ALPR and high-definition video data locally at the intersection level, minimizing expensive cloud egress fees. This edge processing must be backed by massive, infinitely scalable, and CJIS-compliant unstructured storage arrays at the core municipal data center to handle evidentiary retention mandates.

Initiative 3: Digital Transparency, GIS Expansion, and the IT Capital Projects Dashboard

- **The Executive Mandate:** To foster public trust, streamline cross-agency data sharing, and maintain its prestigious status as a Top 10 Digital City, the Edwards administration mandates unprecedented public visibility into how taxpayer dollars are allocated and spent.[8] Transparency is viewed as a political necessity to justify the severe budget cuts to the populace.
- **The Specific High-Spend Agency Owning It:** The Information Services department, specifically the Geographic Information Systems (GIS) Division managed by Warren Kron, and the Information Services Outreach Coordinator's team.[19]
- **The Underlying IT Requirement:** In late 2025, the City-Parish launched a comprehensive "IT Capital Projects Dashboard," designed to provide residents with real-time, interactive updates on the status, timeline, and funding of major infrastructure projects.[8]

Furthermore, the city's ArcGIS portal hosts massive, data-dense interactive maps for regional drainage, historic imagery overlays, near real-time traffic resources, and the tracking of the MOVEBR transportation initiatives.[21] This transparency initiative drives a relentless, compounding demand for Tier-1 compute, high-availability virtualization, and high-end client endpoints. GIS analysts, data scientists, and programmers require advanced mobile workstations equipped with dedicated GPUs for complex 3D rendering and dataset manipulation. Meanwhile, the backend infrastructure requires highly available, fault-tolerant virtualized server clusters to ensure that public-facing dashboards and critical 311 mapping tools never experience downtime, particularly during extreme weather events or hurricanes when public access to infrastructure data is a matter of life and safety.[19]

6. Procurement, Vendor Landscape, & Compliance

The Procurement Ecosystem

The City-Parish of Baton Rouge utilizes a highly structured, regulated procurement environment managed centrally by the City-Parish Purchasing Division, augmented by a digital Vendor Self-Service (VSS) portal.[35] To bypass lengthy, complex, and highly litigious local Request for Proposal (RFP) processes, the City-Parish heavily leverages cooperative purchasing agreements and pre-negotiated state contracts to execute technology acquisitions rapidly.

- **Primary Contract Vehicles:**
  - **Louisiana State Contracts (LA eCat / LaPS):** The Louisiana Office of State Procurement provides a comprehensive pricing schedule (LaPS) that is fully accessible to local municipal entities. This is the preferred method for standard hardware and software acquisitions, as the pricing and legal terms are pre-vetted by the state.[36]
  - **Cooperative Agreements (NASPO ValuePoint & OMNIA Partners):** The City-Parish widely utilizes these national cooperatives for complex hardware, unified software licensing, and hybrid cloud solutions.[38]
  - **GSA Schedule 8F (via Aggregators like Carahsoft):** Utilized for highly complex software acquisitions, cybersecurity platforms, and specialized analytics tools that may not be present on local state schedules.[38]

The Battlefield & Vendor Footprint

The current enterprise technology landscape in Baton Rouge is a highly contested battlefield, defined by aging infrastructure, massive impending contract expirations, and entrenched software ecosystems.

- **Compute & Endpoint Incumbents (The Imminent Threat/Opportunity):** The State of Louisiana currently holds massive, active contracts for "Computer Equip/Peripherals" with

both Dell (Contract 4400028252) and HP Inc. (Contract 4400028088).[37] Critically, both of these massive statewide agreements officially expired on **June 30, 2025**.[37] This recent expiration has triggered an ongoing, highly competitive battlefield for endpoint and peripheral market share in 2026. With the City-Parish operating under severe austerity, the vendor that secures the next iteration or extensions of these contracts with the most aggressive pricing and the most robust lifecycle management services will dominate the municipal endpoint space for the next half-decade.

- **The Public Safety Ecosystem:** The BRPD Real Time Crime Center is deeply entrenched with Genetec (Citigraf and Omnicast VMS), Axon (body cameras, Fleet, and the Fusus real-time platform integration), and Motorola (dispatch and ALPR software).[17] This ecosystem generates petabytes of unstructured video and metadata.
- **Storage & Core Infrastructure:** Data Unavailable regarding the specific, singular incumbent for the City-Parish's primary Storage Area Network (SAN). However, the aggressive push toward a consolidated digital infrastructure initiated in 2012 implies that legacy, siloed storage arrays purchased during the last major modernization cycle are currently reaching end-of-life status, falling off maintenance contracts, and are ripe for consolidation. The budgetary reality that forced the cancellation of the ShotSpotter contract underscores a critical vulnerability for incumbent competitors offering expensive, subscription-based cloud platforms.[10] Any vendor relying heavily on escalating OpEx renewals is highly vulnerable to competitive displacement by capitalized, on-premises solutions.

Compliance Drivers

Technology purchases within the City-Parish are heavily dictated by strict local, state, and federal compliance mandates.

- **CJIS (Criminal Justice Information Services):** Any technology—compute, storage, or networking—touching the RTCC, BRPD evidentiary data, or dispatch systems must adhere strictly to CJIS security policies, including strict data encryption and access auditing.[41]
- **AI Governance Mandates:** CIO Rizwan Ahmed is specifically tasked with AI governance.[13] Any AI infrastructure procured must offer transparent data lineage, secure enclave computing, and comprehensive auditability to prevent algorithmic bias in civic processes like code enforcement, hiring, or policing.
- **Federal Grant Stipulations & ICAP (2 CFR 200):** Purchases utilizing federal SLCGP or ARP funds must comply with 2 CFR Part 200 standards.[27] Furthermore, because Baton Rouge shares IT infrastructure with St. George, all systems must support the metrics required by the city's Indirect Cost Allocation Plan (ICAP) to ensure legal compliance regarding cross-jurisdictional billing.[25]

7. Actionable Dell Opportunities

Based on an exhaustive synthesis of the City-Parish's extreme fiscal constraints, the 33% reduction in the General Fund workforce, the overarching political prioritization of public safety, and the arrival of an enterprise-focused CIO in Rizwan Ahmed, the following represent high-probability, actionable sales motions for Dell Technologies and its channel partners.

Funded Alignment: The AI-Ready Workforce Multiplier Map directly to Initiative 1 (AI-Driven Operational Automation). The City-Parish is legally and financially barred from hiring human beings to fill the 420 deleted General Fund positions; therefore, it must buy compute to automate those lost workflows. CIO Rizwan Ahmed is mandated to implement AI to bridge this operational gap.[7]

- **The Dell Play:** Dell Account Executives must aggressively position the **Dell AI Factory with NVIDIA** and high-density **PowerEdge XE servers** as the foundational, capitalized infrastructure for Baton Rouge's automation strategy. Because the Finance Department vehemently opposes recurring OpEx [7], Dell should pitch a fully on-premises or co-located AI infrastructure that is procured outright as a capital asset. This high-performance infrastructure will power the natural language processing models required for the automated 311 call center and the predictive analytics used for blight demolition triage. By positioning Dell's AI-ready infrastructure not as an "IT upgrade," but as a "workforce continuity" CapEx investment, the Dell AE can align directly with the Mayor-President's budgetary reality, offering a one-time purchase that permanently reduces the need for human labor.

Whitespace & Advisory: The Edge-to-Core Public Safety Data Strategy Map directly to Initiative 2 (RTCC Consolidation). The BRPD's Real Time Crime Center is generating unsustainable, exponential amounts of unstructured video data via Axon, Genetec, and private community cameras.[17] The fact that BRPD cut the ShotSpotter platform strictly to save $400,000 indicates that the department is highly sensitive to ballooning cloud storage and vendor subscription fees.[10]

- **The Dell Play:** Dell must lead with high-level advisory services targeting unstructured data sprawl within law enforcement. The AE should position **Dell PowerScale (formerly Isilon)** as the ultimate, CJIS-compliant central repository for all Genetec and Axon video feeds. BRPD needs a vendor-agnostic storage backend so they are not held hostage by proprietary camera vendors charging premium cloud egress fees for evidentiary retention. Furthermore, Dell should introduce **Dell NativeEdge** orchestration and ruggedized **PowerEdge XR** servers for deployment at street-level intersections and remote police precincts. This architecture allows BRPD to run ALPR and video analytics at the edge, sending only critical text metadata back to the core data center. This drastically reduces network bandwidth costs, lowers cloud dependency, and ensures continuous operation even if regional networks are disrupted by hurricanes.

Competitive Displacement: Repatriating Cloud Spend via APEX Map directly to Section 4 (Financials & Budget Breakdown). With a staggering $15 million cut to the General Fund, every

recurring IT subscription is currently under hostile, line-by-line review by the Budgeting Division.[7] Cloud environments that were spun up rapidly during the pandemic are likely generating massive, unpredictable monthly bills that violate the new administration's strict fiscal conservatism.

- **The Dell Play:** Execute a targeted cloud repatriation intervention. The Dell AE should offer the use of tools like Dell Live Optics to assess the City-Parish's current public cloud spend across Azure or AWS. Present a competitive displacement strategy utilizing **Dell APEX Custom Solutions**. APEX allows Baton Rouge to bring its critical workloads back on-premises (regaining absolute control, ensuring CJIS compliance, and boosting performance) while maintaining a predictable, cloud-like consumption model. Crucially, the Dell AE can work directly with the City-Parish Finance Department to structure the APEX agreement in a way that aligns optimally with their Indirect Cost Allocation Plans (ICAP). By providing granular metering, APEX allows the central IS department to accurately measure and charge back compute and storage usage to the independent City of St. George, solving a massive legal and financial friction point for the CIO.

Funded Alignment: 2026 Endpoint Battlefield & Digital Transparency Map directly to Initiative 3 and the Procurement Battlefield. The State of Louisiana's prevailing Computer Equipment and Peripherals contracts for both Dell (4400028252) and HP (4400028088) reached their expiration on June 30, 2025.[37] Concurrently, the City-Parish is aggressively expanding its GIS mapping capabilities, Open Data portals, and the new IT Capital Projects Dashboard.[8]

- **The Dell Play:** Initiate an aggressive **Client Solutions Group (CSG)** displacement and refresh campaign to capture post-contract expiration market share. Target Warren Kron's GIS department and the Outreach Coordinator's team with top-tier **Dell Precision Workstations**. The AE must emphasize that advanced 3D visualization, digital storytelling, and the management of massive transparency dashboards require dedicated client-side GPUs and immense processing power that standard enterprise laptops cannot deliver. Furthermore, position **Dell Latitude Rugged** devices for the BRPD patrol fleet and Public Works field teams who are out in the elements managing the physical infrastructure upgrades championed by the Mayor-President. Capturing this endpoint refresh is critical to defending Dell's footprint against HP in the state.

Whitespace & Advisory: SLCGP Zero-Trust Architecture Map directly to Section 4 (Grants & Funding). The state has $1.6 million in federal SLCGP funds available, capping at $200,000 per local entity.[30]

- **The Dell Play:** Engage CIO Rizwan Ahmed with a grant-funded security advisory motion. Position **Dell PowerProtect Cyber Recovery** and **Data Manager** to build a secure, air-gapped cyber vault for the City-Parish. Since SLCGP funds are strictly dedicated to systemic risk reduction and cannot be used for standard operational upgrades [30], a Cyber Recovery vault perfectly aligns with the federal grant's stipulations. This offers the

City-Parish a heavily subsidized (20% matched) pathway to securing its critical 311 databases, ERP systems, and public safety data against crippling ransomware attacks, ensuring civic continuity during the most turbulent administrative transition in the city's history.

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